

Extending AppFolio Max Into Building Access Control

A case study for midsized property operators using dormakaba Community software and Comelit

White paper and case study

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Executive summary

Property-management companies with more than 500 units often occupy an uncomfortable position. They are large enough to need reliable automation across accounting, leasing and building systems, but they may have limited in-house capacity to connect those systems and automate workflows between them. Many choose AppFolio because it provides a capable property-management platform at a lower cost and with less implementation complexity than prominent enterprise systems.

That decision can leave an integration gap. AppFolio contains the resident, lease, unit, move-in and move-out information, while the building's access-control system governs physical entry. Without a reliable connection, staff must repeat the same resident lifecycle work in both systems.

Established system providers

dormakaba and Community. dormakaba Holding AG is a global access-solutions company whose products include electronic locks, access-control hardware and access-management software. Its Community Access Management Software is a web-based multifamily platform for administering resident and staff credentials, apartment and common-area permissions, and access activity. A prebuilt connection between dormakaba Community software and AppFolio was not available for this project.

dormakaba is a publicly traded Swiss company listed on the SIX Swiss Exchange, not a subsidiary owned by a single corporate parent. As of June 30, 2026, it reported a market capitalization of CHF 2.17 billion. Its fiscal 2025/26 results included CHF 2.79 billion in net sales, CHF 185.2 million in net profit, a 16.1% adjusted EBITDA margin and an investment-grade BBB/stable rating from S&P. Its listed-share ownership consisted of 71.0% public shareholders, 27.7% held through a shareholder pool representing Mankel/Brecht-Bergen and former Kaba-family interests, and 1.0% treasury shares. These measures establish dormakaba as a substantial, publicly accountable access-technology provider.

Comelit. Comelit Group S.p.A. is a privately held, family-run Italian security-technology company founded in 1956. It designs and manufactures video door-entry, access-control, video-surveillance, intrusion-detection and fire-protection systems. Comelit reports more than 1,000 employees, 14 group companies, eight research-and-development centers and sales in more than 90 countries. Its 2024 Sustainability Report reports EUR 189 million in group turnover. The recent European acquisition involving Comelit was not a purchase of Comelit: on July 31, 2026, Comelit completed its acquisition of 100% of the German Ritto door-entry business from Schneider Electric. Comelit reported that it financed the transaction entirely from its own resources, which it cited as evidence of its financial position and sustainable growth strategy. Because Comelit remains privately held and is not exchange-listed, it has no public stock-market capitalization; its disclosed turnover, operating scale, international footprint and internally funded acquisition are the appropriate public indicators of company substance.

Comelit provides stronger publicly documented evidence of operating scale and internally generated financial capacity. ButterflyMX provides evidence of significant customer adoption and institutional investor support, but its private financial results are not publicly available. Neither company has a public market capitalization.

Property Ops Studio fills the connection gap for qualified AppFolio Max clients. In the case described here, Property Ops Studio connected AppFolio with dormakaba Community Access Management Software at a 118-unit Class A multifamily property with retail in Glendale, California. The property retained its dormakaba keyless-entry and access-control environment and its Comelit video-entry system. Routine move-in and move-out activity could then drive the corresponding resident-access workflow without requiring the management company to build a specialized integration team.

The business case rests on three points:

- The client retained a complete access-control system it had already purchased.

- Property Ops Studio supplied a focused AppFolio-to-dormakaba Community software integration for \$9,500 per property.
- The integration did not add a separate recurring Property Ops Studio integration-platform subscription.

The approach is designed for midsized operators managing more than 500 units that already use AppFolio Max or are prepared to adopt it as the technical foundation for several operational improvements. AppFolio Max pricing varies by company and is therefore not included in the project-cost illustration.

Why recurring licensing affects property value

Recurring software fees are not just technology costs. When an annual fee is charged to a property and is not offset by measurable savings or additional revenue, it reduces net operating income. Buyers then capitalize that lower NOI into the property's value.

At capitalization rates between 5.5 and 6.0 percent, a net \$10,000 annual expense can reduce property value by approximately \$166,700 to \$181,800.

Net annual NOI reduction	Capitalization rate	Illustrative value reduction
\$10,000	6.00%	\$166,667
\$10,000	5.75%	\$173,913
\$10,000	5.50%	\$181,818

This is why the payment structure matters. The Glendale configuration uses a one-time \$9,500 Property Ops Studio integration fee, with technical support billed only when requested. The reviewed scope identifies no separate recurring Property Ops Studio platform subscription or annual per-unit or per-door access-platform license for the deployed dormakaba Community software, Comelit and Property Ops Studio configuration.

RemoteLock and ButterflyMX use recurring commercial models. RemoteLock publishes multifamily pricing beginning at \$6 per door per month under an annual contract. ButterflyMX publishes an annual software range of \$30 to \$42 per apartment, with final pricing affected by features and integrations.

Access-software model	Published or documented fee structure	Five-year illustration	Ten-year illustration
Glendale dormakaba Community software, Comelit and Property Ops Studio configuration	\$9,500 one-time integration fee; no separate recurring Property Ops Studio platform subscription or annual per-unit/per-door access-platform license identified in the reviewed scope	\$9,500	\$9,500
RemoteLock published multifamily starting price	From \$6 per door per month under an annual contract	\$41,400 using 115 resident doors	\$82,800 using 115 resident doors
ButterflyMX published software range	\$30 to \$42 per apartment per year	\$17,700 to \$24,780 for 118 apartments	\$35,400 to \$49,560 for 118 apartments

These figures compare recurring software charges, not complete installed systems. They exclude inflation, hardware, installation, onboarding, common-area and elevator requirements, premium features, additional

integrations and support outside the published package. The RemoteLock illustration uses only the 115 resident doors, and the ButterflyMX illustration is a published base range rather than a quote for this property.

The broader platforms may be worthwhile when their additional features produce enough revenue, labor savings or risk reduction to offset the subscription. But when the existing access and video-entry systems already meet the property's needs, a focused one-time integration can automate the routine workflow without adding another permanent annual expense. The valuation figures illustrate the effect of avoided net expense; they are not a promise of value created by every Property Ops Studio engagement.

The target client

Property Ops Studio is positioned for a property-management company with the following profile:

- More than 500 units under management
- AppFolio Max in use or planned
- Limited in-house capacity to connect business systems and automate workflows
- Existing or planned investments in property-specific systems such as access control, intercoms and Wi-Fi networking
- Repetitive workflows that cross system boundaries
- A preference for fixed project pricing over another integration subscription charged by unit or door

The 500-unit threshold is a Property Ops Studio target qualification, not an AppFolio licensing requirement. Below that scale, the cost of AppFolio Max and a custom integration may be difficult to justify unless the same technical foundation supports several properties or multiple automation projects.

Why this market exists

AppFolio competes with property-management systems that serve different operating scales and pricing models. Yardi Breeze is a closer price-market comparison for smaller portfolios. Yardi Voyager, RealPage Essentials and OneSite, and Entrata fall into the higher-cost, custom-quoted and module-based category relevant to this case study. These systems may also require additional implementation, training, consulting and product configuration.

The case-study management company previously licensed a full complement of RealPage modules. It reports that converting to AppFolio reduced its annual property-management software subscription expense by many thousands of dollars. That is the client's actual experience rather than a claim that every AppFolio agreement is cheaper than every Yardi, RealPage or Entrata agreement.

Property management system	Market position	Public cost and integration context
Yardi Breeze and Breeze Premier	Smaller and cost-sensitive portfolios	Public Breeze pricing materials do not establish that third-party API access is included. Interface availability should be confirmed for the client's specific product and agreement.
AppFolio Max	Midsized operators that need customization and API access	Current pricing is quote based. Max provides AppFolio's read and write Database API and is the required foundation for the Property Ops Studio model described here.
Yardi Voyager	Enterprise and complex portfolios	Pricing is customized and module based. Yardi offers Voyager APIs through its Interface Partner Program, which requires an annual license fee per interface and a data-exchange agreement for each interface type. The case-study company considered but declined a move to Yardi Voyager because remaining with AppFolio preserved annual software savings of many thousands of dollars.
RealPage Essentials and OneSite	Higher-cost, custom-quoted and module-based property-management environments comparable to Yardi Voyager and Entrata	Public information reviewed does not establish API access as included with RealPage Essentials. OneSite does offer APIs through RealPage Exchange and the AppPartner program; available documentation and access depend on the routes and methods licensed to the customer. The case-study company reports saving many thousands of dollars annually after replacing its full complement of RealPage modules with AppFolio.
Entrata	Midsized and enterprise multifamily operators	Pricing is customized. API use requires an agreement and explicit access under the customer's Entrata environment.

For this target client, replacing AppFolio with an enterprise PMS merely to obtain a building-system connection would be disproportionate. Property Ops Studio instead helps the client use its AppFolio Max investment more effectively.

The access control project

The 118-unit Class A multifamily property with retail in Glendale, California, required a full keyless-entry and access-control environment. The revised signed project scope covered:

- 115 resident doors with dormakaba Saffire interconnected electronic locks
- 12 common-area doors or gates
- Two elevator access points
- dormakaba Community access-management software
- dormakaba Community software server and workstation components
- Mobile-interface and Aurora integration components
- RFID credentials for residents and vehicles
- Installation, programming, configuration and training
- Two Comelit Ultra directory systems
- 118 Comelit non-subscription licenses
- Comelit integration licensing for dormakaba Community software

The equipment contractor furnished and installed the access-control and video-entry infrastructure. Property Ops Studio did not select or sell the locks, Comelit panels or access-control hardware for the completed

project. Its role was to supply the missing software integration between AppFolio and dormakaba Community software. Property Ops Studio can assist with product evaluation on future projects, but that service is separate from the completed integration described here.

How the system works

Each product retains a defined responsibility.

System	Responsibility in the completed environment
AppFolio Max	Holds the resident, lease, property, unit and move-date information used by the approved workflow
Property Ops Studio integration	Translates the approved AppFolio resident lifecycle event into the corresponding dormakaba Community software action
dormakaba Community Access Management Software	Manages resident access, unit relationships, credentials, common-area authorization and supported access devices
Comelit	Provides the property's video-entry and visitor-entry functions through the installed entrance systems

For the approved workflow, the integration can use AppFolio move-in and move-out information to establish or update the resident relationship in dormakaba Community software, associate the resident with the correct unit when the necessary data is available, and deactivate access at move-out. Specialty fobs, unusual permissions and manual exceptions remain under authorized administration in dormakaba Community software.

This division matters. The integration simplifies a routine operating handoff without attempting to replace the security functions of dormakaba Community software or the resident-entry functions of Comelit.

Operational benefit

Resident turnover affects both the lease record and physical access. Without an integration, employees must recreate resident data in the access system, confirm the unit, coordinate effective dates and later remove access. The process depends on staff remembering a second system and completing the work at the correct time. This became a significant concern for the executive team because the company could not consistently rely on every site employee, new hire or temporary worker to complete the same manual handoff correctly and on schedule. What appeared to be a routine site task had become a broader management-control issue affecting operating consistency and access administration.

The staffing and training problem

Management identified a recurring risk: new and temporary staff were not always trained to administer access control consistently. Resident additions, unit assignments and move-out deactivations could therefore be delayed, entered incorrectly or missed.

The same weakness affected other third-party systems that required staff to re-enter information already maintained in the property-management system. Each manual handoff added training demands and another chance for error, making this a process-design issue rather than simply an employee-performance issue.

Property Ops Studio reduces that risk by using approved AppFolio resident lifecycle events to initiate the corresponding dormakaba Community actions. Authorized staff still manage security exceptions, but routine updates no longer depend on every employee remembering when, where and how to re-enter the same data.

The AppFolio-to-dormakaba Community software connection makes the property-management record the operational starting point for the approved move workflow. That provides several practical benefits:

- Less duplicate resident administration
- More consistent unit assignment
- A defined move-out deactivation process
- Fewer missed routine updates during staff turnover or temporary coverage
- Reduced dependence on one employee who understands every access-system step
- Continued use of the property's installed dormakaba and Comelit systems
- A documented integration that can be supported and adapted through an approved scope

The integration is currently operating in beta production. It is not available for a public demonstration because it contains private property and resident information.

Where packaged access platforms fit

RemoteLock and ButterflyMX remain relevant alternatives. Both offer broader packaged access ecosystems, continuing software development and established product support.

RemoteLock provides cloud management across compatible locks and wired access-control devices. Its platform can coordinate credentials with property-management workflows. Larger portfolios, advanced features, onboarding and final integration requirements may require a separate quote beyond the published starting plan.

ButterflyMX provides a broader property-access and resident-experience platform that can include video intercoms, access control, package rooms, vehicle access, smart locks and elevator controls. Its published annual software fee includes its mobile app, feature updates and live support. Hardware is purchased separately, and the final software amount depends on the property's features and integrations.

These products may be the better decision when an owner wants their broader feature set, resident applications, packaged service commitments or a single vendor-supported cloud environment. Their public information does not provide enough detail for a reliable complete installed-system comparison with the dormakaba and Comelit project. The earlier recurring-fee table therefore compares only software-fee structure; it does not claim that the published starting packages provide identical hardware, installation or functionality.

In this case, management reported that the resident population was not expressing dissatisfaction with the access and video-entry services already being provided. The owner therefore did not believe that moving to a more extensive packaged platform would materially improve rent, retention, resident satisfaction or operating performance. Without a demonstrated bottom-line benefit, the broader feature set did not justify adding another permanent annual property expense.

The strategic distinction remains useful. A packaged platform rents a continuing service and may include more capabilities. Property Ops Studio provides a focused integration around systems the owner already owns. An owner should compare the value of the broader features with the subscription's net effect on NOI.

Property Ops Studio service model

Property Ops Studio operates as a specialist for companies that need systems connected but cannot justify maintaining a dedicated in-house integration team.

For the standard AppFolio-to-dormakaba Community software deployment described here:

- Integration fee is \$9,500 per property
- Standard work is priced through a fixed statement of work
- Material changes or property-specific deviations require an approved change order
- Technical support is available at \$125 per hour when requested
- Other Property Ops Studio services are generally offered at \$125 to \$150 per hour or under contract pricing
- No separate recurring Property Ops Studio integration-platform subscription is added

All Property Ops Studio fees and hourly rates stated in this paper are current planning figures, are subject to change and must be confirmed in the applicable proposal or statement of work.

The completed code is available to Property Ops Studio as a reusable foundation for future access-control engagements. The per-property fee recognizes that this foundation can be reused while each deployment still requires local dormakaba Community software coordination, AppFolio property and unit mapping, credentials, endpoint configuration, exception review, testing and a controlled go-live.

When this approach is appropriate

The case is strongest when the client:

- Manages more than 500 units and can use AppFolio Max across multiple operational needs
- Already owns serviceable access-control and video-entry infrastructure
- Needs a defined AppFolio-driven resident lifecycle workflow
- Does not need to replace its locks merely to automate that workflow
- Can assign responsible personnel for exceptions and security-sensitive administration
- Values a fixed one-time integration fee over another property-level recurring integration subscription

A packaged platform may be preferable for a new development, a full hardware replacement, a portfolio standardization program or an owner that needs capabilities beyond the defined workflow.

Conclusion

The completed project demonstrates a practical role for Property Ops Studio. The property already had a complete dormakaba keyless-entry and access-control system and a Comelit video-entry system. AppFolio held the resident lifecycle data. The missing component was a dependable operational connection between them—one that reduced the number of routine access tasks dependent on site-level training and repeated manual entry.

The completed Property Ops Studio foundation supplied that connection for a fixed one-time \$9,500 per-property integration fee. The client retained the software savings it had achieved by replacing its full complement of RealPage modules with AppFolio, avoided building a dedicated team to connect and maintain its business systems, and did not add a separate recurring Property Ops Studio integration-platform subscription.

For a midsized AppFolio Max operator, that combination can improve operations and protect property value. It extends infrastructure the owner already controls while limiting permanent operating expenses that reduce NOI.

Sources

Project scope facts are based on the reviewed revised scope of work, signed access-control agreement, January 2024 estimate and signed Comelit change order for the Glendale project.

- [AppFolio Property Manager pricing and API availability](#)
- [AppFolio 2026 Form 10 K discussion of Core Plus and Max](#)
- [Yardi Breeze pricing](#)
- [Yardi SaaS subscription terms](#)
- [Yardi Interface Partner Program](#)
- [RealPage OneSite](#)
- [RealPage developer portal](#)
- [Entrata API documentation](#)
- [dormakaba Community product information](#)
- [dormakaba 2025/26 market capitalization and corporate information](#)
- [dormakaba 2025/26 key financial figures](#)
- [dormakaba ownership structure](#)
- [Comelit resident video-entry capabilities](#)
- [Comelit Group structure and ownership description](#)
- [Comelit 2024 Sustainability Report](#)
- [Comelit completion of the Ritto acquisition from Schneider Electric](#)
- [RemoteLock pricing](#)
- [ButterflyMX pricing](#)
- [ButterflyMX 2025 company growth and investment update](#)
- [Northmarq 2026 midyear multifamily report](#)

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